



MONEY YOU'RE OWED

Out-the-Door Car Deal Checklist

Five numbers, add-on questions, and the changed-terms script

Complete free answer for V10. This is a comparison worksheet, not a promise that every charge is illegal or negotiable.

Before the dealership

- ☐ Bank/credit-union preapproval amount: ____
- ☐ Preapproval APR: __% · Term: _____ months
- ☐ Maximum out-the-door budget: \$_____
- ☐ Current vehicle payoff from lender: \$____
- ☐ Independent trade-value estimates: \$____
- ☐ Insurance quote for the vehicle: \$_____

The five numbers

1. Out-the-door price — in writing

Line	Amount	Government or dealer?	Required?	What it buys
Vehicle price	\$			
Dealer discount / rebate	\$			
Dealer charges	\$			
Tax	\$			
Title / registration	\$			
Other	\$			
OUT-THE-DOOR TOTAL	\$			

2. Financing

- APR: __%
- Term: _____ months
- Amount financed: \$____
- Finance charge: \$_____
- Total of payments: \$____
- Monthly payment: \$____

A lower monthly payment can still mean a higher total cost. Compare APR, term and total of payments to your preapproval.

3. Add-ons

For **each** service contract, GAP product, wheel/tire plan, paint product, theft product or credit insurance: - Cash price: \$__ - **Financed price / effect on amount financed:** \$__ - **Is it required by the lender, dealer, or neither?** __ - Can I buy the car/loan without it? ____ - **Cancellation/refund terms and deadline:** ____ - Contract received before signing? []

4. Trade-in

- Trade allowance: \$____
- Exact old-loan payoff: \$____
- **Allowance minus payoff:** \$____ = positive equity / negative equity
- Amount of negative equity rolled into new loan: \$____

5. Final contract check

- [] Price, down payment and trade credit match the worksheet
- [] APR, term, amount financed, finance charge and total of payments match
- [] Every add-on is listed and priced
- [] No blank spaces
- [] Promised repair/accessory is in writing
- [] Financing is confirmed final or clearly identified as conditional
- [] Copy of every signed document received

Changed-terms script

These are not the terms I agreed to. Please remove the added product or restore the written price and financing. If you cannot, I am not signing.

If called back after taking the car:

Please give me the original agreement, the written reason the financing changed, and the options under my contract and state law. I will not sign a replacement contract until I have reviewed the complete terms.

Do not assume a universal cooling-off period or automatic right to unwind a signed deal. Document the timeline and check your contract/state rules.

Complaint paths

- **FTC:** deceptive sales practices — reportfraud.ftc.gov
- **CFPB:** covered auto-financing issues — consumerfinance.gov/complaint
- **State:** attorney general / motor-vehicle regulator

Official tools

- CFPB Auto Loans: consumerfinance.gov/consumer-tools/auto-loans/
- CFPB Auto Loan Shopping Sheet: files.consumerfinance.gov/f/documents/201606_cfpb_auto-loan-worksheet.pdf
- FTC CARS Rule status: ftc.gov/legal-library/browse/rules/cars-rule — the rule was vacated; do not rely on it as active protection.

Money You're Owed · General education, not legal, tax or lending advice. Fees, contracts and remedies vary by lender and state. Accurate as of July 2026.